

Event Guide

Saturday 3rd - 9th October 2026

at Weymouth & Portland National Sailing Academy

Osprey Quay, Portland DT5 1SA

Tel: 01305 866000

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Important Notices to all Competitors

- The Owner/Competitor is solely responsible for the safety, management, and insurance of their sailing craft during all activities.
- The issue of sailing instructions, or any other directives, either verbal, written, or implied in no way limits or reduces the complete responsibility of the Owner/Competitor for their crew and the management thereof.
- The Event Organisers, the Host Club, or any Class Association will not be liable for any loss, damage, death, or personal injury howsoever caused to the Owner/Competitor or any of their crew because of their taking part in the event.
- Moreover, every Owner/Competitor warrants the suitability of his/her craft for the trials, race, or races.
- All craft be insured against Third Party Liability for a minimum of £3,000,000. This is a condition of entry to Weymouth Speed Week.

Medical Fitness

You should be medically fit and capable of performing activities that may be physically demanding, such as moving around a boat and swimming. You must also be able to understand and follow safety instructions and are asked to disclose any medical conditions that could affect your safety, or the safety of others, to the event organisers in advance using the form that will be provided.

Briefing

All competitors must attend the morning briefing and receive the Course Director's instructions, including safety information, before sailing.

Rash Vest

All competitors must wear the provided yellow rash vest while on the water.

Whistles

All competitors will receive emergency whistles. It is compulsory that you carry them while sailing. Use them only if you need help.

Tally Bands

It Is compulsory that you collect your Tally Band from the Event Office before going on the water and return it immediately after you finish sailing.

Youth Entries

Weymouth Speed Week encourages the participation of young people. We run a two-day Youth Event over the first weekend with prize giving early on the Sunday evening for those less than 18 years old for both days. But please be aware that the parent or guardian will need to be responsible for their supervision.

In an Emergency

Call WPNSA reception 01305 866000 if an ambulance or the Coastguard are needed. The WPNSA Emergency Guide details the location of defibrillators, first aid and local hospitals. It is available in the Event Office and at locations around the venue.

Safety Issues

To report any safety concerns and to advise your whereabouts if stranded ashore or unable to return to the Event Office promptly after the course closes call 07868 293535.

Entry to the Event

For practical and safety reasons we must limit the total number of competitors.
Entry is only secured on payment of the appropriate fee following completion of on-line registration.

The entry fee includes use of the Weymouth and Portland National Sailing Academy and all launching and mooring fees due to the Portland Port Authority, the Saturday night 'Welcome Supper' and the Event Shirts.

Weymouth Speed Week provides the overall organization and the rash vests, flags, buoys & anchors, GPS units, result software and equipment, support boats, fuel and crews used during the event. The event is non-profit making and run by volunteers. Prizes are provided by our generous event sponsors, please support them.

Competitors may compete with any wind powered sailing craft

The Organisers

Chairman	Nick Povey
Event Manager & Hon Treasurer	Norman Phillips
Event Promotion	Simon Pettifer and Jenna Gibson
Course Director	Karen Battye
Speed Results and Web Site	Mike George/Nick Povey
Graphic Design	www.natural-design.co.uk
Weymouth and Portland National Sailing Academy	Sally Reynoldson

Contact details during Weymouth Speed Week

During the Weymouth Speed Week event the following people will have access to 2-way radios and remain in contact with the Event Office, beach and support boats.

Incident requiring an ambulance or coastguard	01305 866000
WPNSA Reception	01305 866000
Nick Povey	07801 757505
Norman Philips	07763 224585
Event Office	07868 293535

Introduction to Weymouth Speed Week

An event with a rich history of innovation, passion, and fun, driven by the need to go faster.

Weymouth Speed Week began in 1972 under the direction of the Royal Yachting Association. It was the premier event at which boats could demonstrate their prowess, reach world-record breaking speeds and further the advancement of sailing technology.

The speed trials of the 1970's and 80's attracted many thousands of pounds of sponsorship money and competitors attended by invitation. Several world speed records were set and then broken during these years, firstly with the boats and then, as technologies improved, by the windsurfers.

Weymouth witnessed the development of windsurfing and its rapid development until these boards dominated speed events.

Weymouth saw the development of the first kite powered craft and some of the very first kite boarding, with Cory Roseler taking part in the 1980’s.

Recent advances in foils for kites and sailboards have enabled these craft to sail at up to three times wind speed. In 2022, Wingfoilers joined Icarus—one of the first successful foiling boats—at Weymouth Speed Week, marking 50 years since Icarus reached 21.6 knots at the inaugural Weymouth Speed Week in 1972.

Weymouth was the testing ground for Sail Rocket which was developed into Vestas Sail Rocket II and now holds the World Speed Record of 65.45 kt average for 500m. Soon to be challenged by another Weymouth Speed Week competitor, Benoit Gaudiot, with the SP80 project he co-founded.

Portland Harbour

Portland Harbour provides a great location for speed sailing. It is bounded on its southwestern side (the direction from which the prevailing wind blows) by Chesil Bank. Chesil Bank is a huge natural breakwater that stops the waves but not the wind. Shortly after the Autumn Equinox the wind conditions become most favourable and it is at this time that Weymouth Speed Week takes place to provide the best chance of getting ideal speed sailing conditions, that of smooth, strong winds and flat water.



An open competition
Weymouth Speed Week is a unique event; there are NO restrictions as to who may enter, and all types of sailing craft are welcome. If it's wind-powered, it is eligible. The lack of rules provides the ideal proving ground for both experts and dreamers to build the type of craft which, but for Weymouth Speed Week, would never otherwise see the light of day. Many early boat and board designs have since been refined and some of today's fastest craft owe their origins to designs and ideas that were first seen at Weymouth Speed Week.

Today's competition
Each competitor wears an individual GPS data logger that continuously records their speed and location five times per second.

Although an outright World Record may be out of reach at Weymouth Speed Week, the competition is on for breaking the Weymouth Speed Week 500m Harbour Record of 41.21 kt set by James Longmuir in 2019 on a kite board.

Courses are laid out in the harbour each day by the event organisers. Depending upon the prevailing wind conditions they endeavour to set a course best suited to the achievement of the highest speeds. Competitors are free to make as many qualifying runs as they can whilst the course is open; a good run normally takes around 25 to 30 seconds.

Accurate measurement of the 500m course and plotting of each competitor's movements and speed are performed with software using the recorded GPS data.

Details of the 2026 Event

The Weymouth and Portland National Sailing Academy the sailing venue of the 2012 Olympics has all the facilities of a world class sailing club, refreshments are available throughout the day. There is adequate parking for cars and trailers. Campers and motor homes are allowed on the site. For people who want to camp on the site it is important that arrangements are made with the WPNSA. Local by-laws, which limit the area for camping, are strictly enforced and the instructions given by the WPNSA must be followed.

Motor vehicles and trailers should be kept in the designated car parking areas. Slipways must be kept as clear as possible and launching trolleys moved to the boat park.

Insurance
All competitors must have third party insurance cover for £3,000,000

Briefing
All competitors must attend the 09:30 briefing and must, before going on the course, ensure that they have been briefed by one of the course managers and made aware of any safety instructions pertinent to that day.

Safety
If you intend to go on the water, ensure that you have adequate protection from the weather. Life jackets or buoyancy aids should always be worn when on the water. Weight jackets are allowed but must be buoyant. Random checks will be carried out, and disqualification will result if riders do not comply with this rule.

To distinguish Weymouth Speed Week competitors from other people on the water and to aid visibility you must wear a Weymouth Speed Week yellow rash vest. These will be available from the event office; a £20 refundable deposit will be required.

When you go on the water you must take your Tally Band from the Event Office and when you come off the water return it promptly. All competitors receive emergency whistles; you must carry them while sailing. Use them if you need help.

Always remember to look out for people in the water, if you see someone check that they are not in difficulties - do not assume anything. Safety must be of paramount importance. At the Event Office and all support boats there will be someone with a radio and a telephone. If you are aware of any safety problem, report it to them promptly.

Photographs
Photographs and video of the event will be taken by several photographers who will be present throughout the week. Competitors entering the event provide their consent to the use of any images in which they may feature.

Competitor's Support Boats
These are included in the entry fee. However, all boats need a receipt to be shown to the Portland Port 'traffic warden' if you are asked to do so. If you require a receipt, they will be available from the event office.

Courses

Courses are set each day and are announced at the morning briefings. On any given day, we may choose to set one or more courses depending upon the prevailing and anticipated wind conditions. The start line is defined by round anchored buoys that will display the course open/closed flags. **The course is one way only** from the buoys with flags towards the big triangular end marker buoys**.**

Course Open Times
The course(s) are scheduled to open at 10:00 and close at 16:00. Exceptions to this are the first day of Weymouth Speed Week when the course opens at 11:00 and Sunday and Friday when the course will close earlier to allow for prize giving if weather conditions are not improving for high speeds.

If exceptionally good conditions are being experienced the organisers will endeavour to take advantage of these by extending the normal session a further 30 or even 60 minutes. In this event yellow flags will be prominently flown by the support boats. In addition, Tannoy announcements will be made in the launch areas. Similarly, if the forecast winds and tides look exceptional then an early morning start may be declared, check the event notice board before leaving the academy each night and follow the Event WhatsApp group.

Flags
The meaning of the flags flying on the course buoys or support boats are as follows:

- **Red** flag - the course is closed.
- **Green** flag the course is open.
- **Yellow** in addition to green flags flying means that the course is open and staying open beyond the advertised time.

Harbour Courses
On a harbour course a “start gate” is used, this is two round dumpy buoys about 20m apart as shown in the diagram below. Competitors need to pass between, or as close to the buoys as safely possible. An arc of triangular buoys is positioned just more than 500m away as a visual guide to competitors to show the end of the course.



These courses have several advantages:

- they are relatively quick and easy to set up
- wind shifts of 20 degrees or so can be accommodated without the need to reposition the course buoys
- competitors safely “fan out” from the start line as they sail their fastest wind angle with respect to their craft type and style.

Beach Courses
As the name implies beach courses run along the edge of the harbour in the lee of Chesil Bank when south westerly and westerly winds blow and where the smoothest water can be found. **This area is shallow and competitors, especially those using foils, must always remain aware of the water depth**. In the image below the shallow areas are clearly visible. The active area of a beach course can extend from the land out across the harbour sufficiently far that competitors can sail the course either in shallow water or further out in deeper water. The start line is marked with a triangular buoy placed prominently on the beach with round dumpy buoys, with flags, positioned in a straight line out across the harbour. The end of the course, just over 500m away, is indicated with a straight line of triangular buoys parallel to the start line.



When the tide is such that it is not possible for all craft to sail close to the shore the course will be widened and a system of an inner and an outer course will be used with additional outer marker buoys (as in the diagram) both use the same extended start line. Competitors on the shore side will be allowed to return to the start using a centre “lane” of the course. They must follow the briefing instructions and be extra vigilant to ensure they do not impede speed runs in progress.

For either course at the end of day, when all the GPS data is collected, our software will analyse the track and find the point where the competitor crossed the start line. From that point a 500m arc is defined, the run is completed when the competitor is 500m from **their own** start point. Thus, each competitor can sail their preferred course angle, even if it is not square to the lines of buoys at the start.

General Points on Sailing the Courses
It's in your interest to start your run 100m or more from the start of the course and keep sailing fast well beyond the course end marker buoys to ensure the best possible run speed is obtained. Competitors must continue beyond these course markers, so they can safely turn and return to the start line without impeding other competitors. It is NOT acceptable to go up the active course the wrong way. Competitors will be warned, and if necessary, removed from the competition if they do this.

If an extended start shore course is used, other than the depth of water, there is no restriction on who sails where, the diagram assumes that the majority of kite and fin sailors will use the shallower water, but they may if they wish sail further out.

One of the questions that we are frequently asked is. Why does my GPS show a faster 500m speed than you have published? The reason for this is that the results we generate are for the course set on that day. The faster run is most likely to have occurred because the run in to, or run out of, the course was faster when compared to the other end of the run and the 'best' 500m was therefore not entirely on the designated course, but slightly before or after the course.

Definitions

Craft Types

Sailboard Fleet, Craft definition:

- has a sail (or sails) with a pivot at the base attached to the board such that the rider supports the sail. May or may not use foils.

Kiteboard Fleet, Craft definition:

- has a kite (or kites) with lines attached to or held by the rider who is on a board. May or may not use foils.

Wingboard Fleet, Craft definition:

- has a wing (or parawing) attached to or held by the rider who is on a board. May or may not use foils.

Boat Fleet, Craft definition:

- has sails, kites or rotors to propel it and only uses non-stored wind energy as the power source. May or may not have multiple hulls and may or may not use foils.

Craft Type Sub Fleets

Due to the large number of competitors and to encourage competition, the following classes are sub-divided as follows:

Sailboard

Amateur

- Has no sponsorship and receives no financial support from others (e.g. their employer or local shop).
- and has not raced regularly at a national or international level.
- and not a member of the 30 knots club, so yet to achieve a Weymouth Speed Week result exceeding 30 knots on a sailboard.
- and have not previously won an Amateur prize at Weymouth Speed Week.

Gold Fleet

- Receives limited assistance from a sponsor, such as discounted equipment.
- or race regularly at a national or international level.
- or members of the 30 knots club, having previously achieved a Weymouth Speed Week result exceeding 30 knots on a sailboard.
- or previously won an Amateur prize at Weymouth Speed Week.

Pro Fleet

- Derives financial benefit from competing in the sport (e.g. supported by sponsors).
- or professional / semi-professional competitors who are internationally recognised.
- or members of the 35 knots club, having previously achieved a Weymouth Speed Week result exceeding 35 knots on a sailboard.
- or previously won the top prize in the gold fleet at Weymouth Speed Week.

Foil Fleet

- All sailboard competitors using a hydrofoil.
- still regarded as a sailboard but distinct from the fin-based amateur / gold / pro fleets

Female

- All female sailboard competitors excluding those in the Pro-Fleet
- may or may not use foils

Kiteboard

Freeride

- Receives no direct financial benefit from taking part but may get a discount for equipment from an employer, local shop or supplier.
- and does not use specialist race equipment.

Open Class

- Uses specialist race equipment.
- or derives financial benefit from competing in the sport (e.g. supported by sponsors).
- or professional / semi-professional competitors who are internationally recognised.

Wingboard

Freeride

- Receives no direct financial benefit from taking part but may get a discount for equipment from an employer, local shop or supplier.
- and does not use specialist race equipment.
- and has not raced regularly at a national or international level.
- and not a member of the 25 knots club, so yet to achieve a Weymouth Speed Week result exceeding 25 knots on a Wingboard.
- and have not previously won the top prize in the Amateur, or the newer Freeride, Wingboard fleet at Weymouth Speed Week.
-

Open Class

- Uses specialist race equipment.
- or derives financial benefit from competing in the sport (e.g. supported by sponsors).
- or race regularly at a national or international level.
- or members of the 25 knots club, having previously achieved a Weymouth Speed Week result exceeding 25 knots on a Wingboard.
- or previously won the top prize in the Amateur or the newer Freeride Wingboard fleet at Weymouth Speed Week.

Youth Fleet

- Less than 18 years for both days of the Youth Weekend Event. The Youth Fleet competition is during the weekend only and concludes when prizes are awarded on the Sunday evening. However, all Youth runs are included in the overall end of week results so potentially a youth can feature in the end of week prize giving as well.

First Time

- Hasn't competed in Weymouth Speed Week before and qualifies to enter in the Youth, Sailboard Amateur, Kite Freeride or Wingboard Freeride Fleets or,
- the boat has not previously entered with its current ownership and none of the crew have previously competed.

"Legend" Fleet

- Reaches their 65th birthday before, or during, Weymouth Speed Week and wishes to be included in this fleet.

Note:

- Organisers reserve the right to allocate people to a suitable fleet on a discretionary basis. In the event of a dispute, a small committee will discuss the individual(s) and take a vote.

Fairness, Inclusion and Non-Discrimination

The policy of Weymouth Speed Week has fairness and inclusion at its very heart. For the event to be enjoyed by all, there must be inclusive opportunities for people to take part, whilst still allowing everyone to compete on a fair and level playing field. To meet these objectives, Weymouth Speed has two categories.

- Female – participants with a birth sex of female
- Open – participants with a birth sex of male, or otherwise ineligible for the female category

Results

The results are reviewed and approved by the official adjudicator whose decision is final. As Weymouth Speed Week is not controlled by any other organisation or governing body, any decisions taken by the organisers are final and not subject to review by third parties.

Weymouth Speed Week allow the ISWC, UKWA and BKSA access to the results of members of those organisations and separately they adjudicate any results that they may wish to use for their own purposes.

Results are processed based upon the contents of the GPS data files recorded by each competitor's Data Logger and with the published gates; the position of which is defined using the same GPS technology.

The Organisers are not responsible for the quality of the data recorded by the GPS unit and any variances or exclusions caused by loss of satellite signal. All competitors can mitigate the risks by wearing their GPS as instructed. Not underneath neoprene or Lycra and worn above their bicep with the labels to the sky.

Motion GPS

The "4 RULES":

1. **DON'T touch the button!**
2. **Check the red light flashes every 10 seconds**
3. **Wear it securely on the outside of your upper arm "labels to the sky" – lost units = £120**
4. **Bring it back promptly each day**

All competitors will be provided with a dedicated GPS. These will be provided to you each morning labelled, charged, and turned on. The LED will flash red every 10 seconds to indicate that the unit is running.

If you have chosen to sail two craft types, you are only able to change from one craft type to another **after** visiting the Event Office with your GPS to secure the data and reset it for the second craft type. You will need to record the time, the craft type just sailed and the craft type to be sailed.

When you have finished sailing each day bring the unit back to the office with the LED still flashing. DO NOT try to turn it off. We will read the data and prepare the unit for you to collect the next morning.

Competitors can use their own unit in addition so they can see how they are performing, so long as the unit meets the minimum standards required and is properly configured (see below) it could be used as a back-up device.

After the event we will make available all the GPS data so you can keep a copy of your data from the WSW units. We will also publish the gates used and the course times.

Suitable GPS back up devices

Locosys	**Motion**	**ESP**
GT-31	LCD	ESP
GW-52	Mini	LISA
GW-60		SYRAC

Settings

	Memory card	**Data logger**
GT31	log switch = "on-fix"	interval = 1 sec
	min speed = 5	min speed = 5
	NMEA items = SBN	
	file size = card size	

GW-52 and GW-60
Logging frequency = 5 Hz and Minimum speed = 5

For all Lycosys units please be sure to clear the log before the first day of WSW.

Motion LCD and Mini, ESP, LISA, SYRAC
Logging frequency = 5 Hz

Prizes

Each day, 'traditional' Weymouth Speed Week prizes are awarded in the form of engraved tankards, sponsored by the Amateur Yacht Research Society. These recognise the fastest Boat, Sailboard, Wingboard, and Kiteboard daily, and are presented at the 09:30 briefing the following morning. Additionally, sponsors are presenting prizes that will be awarded at the conclusion of the week and to the Youth Fleet following their two days of competition. Categories for which, at a minimum, prizes and/or trophies will be awarded include:

Overall

- Fastest
- Fastest Female
- Fastest Legend

Youth

- 1st, 2nd and 3rd Fastest

Sailboard

- Fastest Sailboard
- Pro Fleet Sailboard
- Foil Fleet Sailboard
- Gold Fleet Sailboard
- Amateur Sailboard
- First Time Sailboard
- Female Sailboard

Kiteboard

- Fastest Kiteboard
- Open Class Kiteboard
- Freeride Kiteboard
- First Time Kiteboard
- Female Kiteboard

Wingboard

- Fastest Wingboard
- Open Class Wingboard
- Freeride Wingboard
- First Time Wingboard
- Female Wingboard

Boat

- Fastest Boat

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Itinerary for the Week

Saturday 3rd^h October

- Briefing 10:30.
- Course opens 11:00 close 16:00.
- From 18:30 at the WPNSA – Welcome Supper – free entry for all competitors, £15 for additional tickets.

Sunday 4^h October

- Briefing 09:30.
- Course opens 10:00 close 16:00.
- 18:00 Youth Prize giving.
- From 19:00. The Marquis of Granby 383-391, Chickerell Rd, Weymouth DT4 9TW. Sunday Roast Special. Tables will be set aside for Weymouth Speed Week competitors and partners.

Monday 5th October

- Welcome & Briefing 09:30.
- Course opens 10:00 close 16:00.
- Skittles NEW VENUE from 20.30. The Portland Social Club, 3 High Street, Portland, DT5 1JQ.

Tuesday 6th October

- Briefing 09:30.
- Course opens 10:00 close 16:00.
- Pizza NEW VENUE from 18:00. Portland Pizza at the Black Barge, Mulberry Avenue, Portland. DT5 1FA.

Wednesday 7^h October

- Briefing 09:30.
- Course opens 10:00 close 16:00.
- Amateur Yacht Research Society evening at the Weymouth Sailing Club, Hope St, Weymouth DT4 8TX (at the end of Nothe Parade) in Weymouth. All welcome. Many good eating places nearby. Bar open from 19:00 talks shortly after that.

Thursday 8th October

- Briefing 09:30.
- Course opens 10:00 close 16:00.
- 19:00 The Fat Badger, 90 Camp Road, Weymouth, DT4 9HF.

Friday 9th October

- Briefing 09:30.
- Course opens 10:00 close at 15:00.
- 18:00 Grand Prize giving. WPNSA main restaurant/meeting room.
- End of event meal. The Marquis of Granby 383-391, Chickerell Rd, Weymouth DT4 9TW.

Portland Harbour Map



